

Second Sunday After Pentecost

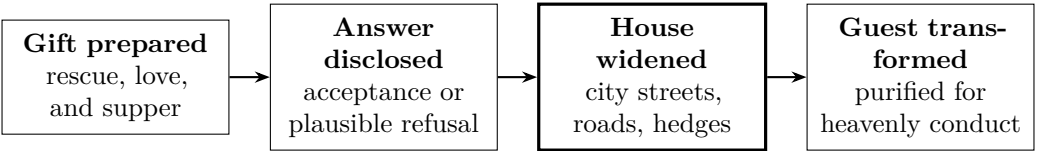
Dominica Secunda Post Pentecosten

1962 TLM: the invitation tested by charity in deed and truth

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Factus est Dominus protector meus</i> (Ps. 17:19-20)	Rescue into breadth	The Lord protects, saves, and brings the worshipper into a wide place because he wills him.
Collect	Perpetual fear and love of the holy Name	Reverence and stable love	God does not abandon those whom he establishes in the solidity of his love.
Epistle	1 John 3:13-18	From death to life; deed and truth	Christ's self-gift becomes the measure of material mercy toward the needy brother.
Gradual	<i>Ad Dominum, cum tribularer, clamavi</i> (Ps. 119:1-2)	Truthful speech	The cry for deliverance from lying lips prepares the hearer to recognize excuses as disordered speech.
Alleluia	<i>Domine Deus meus, in te speravi</i> (Ps. 7:2)	Hope under persecution	Hope asks God for the rescue promised in the Introit amid the world's hatred of the brethren.
Gospel	Luke 14:16-24	The great supper	Excuses disclose resistance; the invitation reaches the poor and then the roads and hedges.
Offertory	<i>Domine, convertere, et eripe animam meam</i> (Ps. 6:5)	The Lord's return and rescue	The imperative addresses God: return, O Lord, deliver my soul, and save me for your mercy's sake.
Secret	<i>Oblatio nos, Domine, tuo nomini dicanda purificet ... de die in diem ad caelestis vitae transferat actionem</i>	Purified and redirected conduct	The oblation dedicated to God's Name is asked to purify the offerers and day by day transfer their conduct toward heavenly life.
Communion	<i>Cantabo Domino, qui bona tribuit mihi</i> (Ps. 12:6)	Thanksgiving for benefits	The communicant sings because the supper and every good are first received as gift.
Postcommunion	<i>Sumptis muneribus sacris</i>	Growth in salvation	Frequent participation in the mystery is asked to increase salvation's effect.
Sense	Synthesis		
Literal	At a Pharisee's table, Jesus tells of invited guests who refuse a prepared supper; the householder then brings in the poor, feeble, blind, and lame and sends his servant farther out until the house is filled.		
Allegorical	Augustine reads the host as Christ and the prepared supper as Christ's saving gift proclaimed by the apostles; in the Mass, the parable also examines readiness for Eucharistic communion.		
Moral	First John tests the response to invitation: one passes from death to life by brotherly love, opens material goods to the needy, and loves in deed and truth rather than by an excuse-making tongue.		
Anagogical	The supper points toward the heavenly banquet; the Secret asks for conduct transferred toward heavenly life, and the Postcommunion asks that sacramental participation increase salvation's effect.		

The Prepared Supper and the Tested Response

The Gospel's supper is prepared before any guest answers. That priority governs the whole Sunday. The Lord first protects and brings into breadth; the Collect asks him to establish love; the host prepares, sends, and sends again; the altar asks that an oblation purify the invited; Communion thanks the giver of good things. The human answer is urgent and morally serious, but it is always an answer to prior gift.



Editorial liturgical synthesis. Luke directly supplies the prepared supper, successive invitations, and full house. Relating those movements to the chants, Secret, and Postcommunion is this guide's reading of the appointed formulary, not a patristic claim about its composition.

Luke places the parable at a Pharisee's table after a guest blesses the one who will eat bread in God's kingdom. The saying is therefore not distant banquet imagery. It tests the present hearer: admiration for the kingdom can coexist with refusal when the actual summons interrupts possession, investigation, or pleasure.

Who Is the Host? Three Patristic Readings

The Fathers agree that the supper is the saving abundance given in Christ and that earlier invitation belongs within Israel's history. They distribute the narrative roles differently. Those differences are interpretive emphases rather than a problem to be flattened into one allegedly unanimous diagram.

Witness and locus	Host, supper, and servant	Historical movement	Contribution and limit
Tertullian, <i>Against Marcion</i> IV.31	The Creator is the host and eternal life the abundant supper.	The patriarchs and fathers receive the first invitation; prophetic admonition summons their descendants; the poor are welcomed in continuity with Isaiah.	His anti-Marcionite purpose establishes one Creator and one economy across the Testaments. It is not a complete role-by-role commentary.
St. Augustine, <i>Sermon</i> 62.1	Christ the Mediator is host; the supper is his saving gift, explicitly including the Eucharistic food offered daily; the apostles issue the summons.	Prophets first invited Israel; Christ's death prepares the feast; apostolic preaching announces that all is ready.	Augustine concentrates the whole economy in Christ and then turns quickly to the hearer's interior readiness.
St. Cyril of Alexandria, <i>Commentary on Luke</i>, Sermon 104	The Father prepares the supper in Christ; the one servant signifies the Son's incarnation and ministry.	Synagogue leaders refuse, ordinary Jewish hearers are gathered from the city, and the apostolic mission reaches the Gentile roads.	Cyril names forgiveness, cleansing, the Spirit, adoption, and the kingdom as the feast's gifts. His servant mapping differs from Augustine's without denying apostolic agency.
St. Gregory the Great, <i>Homiliae in Evangelia</i> II.36	The great supper is the eternal sweetness offered by God.	He turns from narrative roles to the psychology of desire and the contradiction between faith and conduct.	Spiritual goods may initially seem unattractive but deepen desire when tasted; bodily pleasures often reverse that pattern. This is moral reception, not a historical map.

A comparison that preserves mystery

Tertullian protects Old and New Testament continuity; Augustine shows the feast prepared through Christ's self-gift and proclaimed by the apostles; Cyril distinguishes the Father's giving and the Son's incarnate mission; Gregory examines the will that encounters the invitation. No single mapping should be made to cancel the others' stated theological purpose.

Three Excuses and the Love Beneath Them

In *Sermon 62.2–7* Augustine joins the three excuses to the threefold worldly desire of 1 John 2:16. His allegory does not condemn land, sense knowledge, or marriage. It exposes the governing love that can turn a lawful good into a courteous refusal of the giver.

Excuse	Augustine's interpretation	Johannine disorder	How this Sunday's Epistle tests it
An estate bought and inspected	The appetite to dominate through possession: the field of rule displaces the kingdom one is invited to receive.	Pride of life.	One who closes worldly goods against a needy brother reveals that possession has not become charity.
Five yoke of oxen to be proved	The five bodily senses and a curiosity that grants authority only to what can be experimentally inspected.	Lust or curiosity of the eyes.	The passage from death to life is known through brotherly love, a spiritual reality that nonetheless becomes visible in deed.
A wife newly married	Fleshly delight made ultimate, so that an intimate created good becomes exemption from the Creator's summons.	Lust of the flesh.	Christ's laying down his life supplies the form of love: communion turns outward in costly self-gift rather than closing around pleasure.

Guardrails for Augustine's allegory

- The literal guests are culpable for refusing an invitation already accepted, but Augustine's symbolic identifications are a spiritual reading, not Luke's exhaustive lexical meaning.
- Property, empirical inquiry, bodily life, and marriage remain genuine goods. Disorder appears when any good becomes a reason the giver may no longer command.
- The threefold parallel with 1 John 2:16 belongs to Augustine's sermon; the connection to this Sunday's separate Epistle from 1 John 3 is an editorial canonical synthesis.

Gregory the Great sharpens the diagnosis. One may confess faith and still contradict the banquet by conduct. Bodily pleasures can be intensely desired before possession and leave disgust afterward; spiritual delight is often resisted before it is tasted but enlarges desire as it is possessed. The problem is not simply a bad decision at one moment. The will has been trained to experience the lesser good as urgent and the supper as postponable.

The Poor, the Roads, and "Compel Them"

The host's anger does not cancel generosity. It redirects the servants toward the poor, feeble, blind, and lame, then beyond the city into roads and hedges until the house is filled. Patristic interpretations of these groups illuminate the history of mission, but they require careful limits.

Narrative turn	Cyril, Sermon 104	Augustine, <i>Sermon 62.8</i>
City streets and lanes	People within Israel who lacked the prestige of the rejecting synagogue leaders are gathered into Christ's gifts.	Those who know their need replace guests confident in their sufficiency.
Roads and hedges	The command reaches the Gentiles through the universal apostolic mission; Cyril closes with Matthew 28.	Roads signify Gentile wandering; hedges signify divided or obstructed hearers whom Augustine associates with heresy.
<i>Compelle intrare</i>	Divine urgency and drawing operate without making faith involuntary; Cyril insists on willing belief.	Augustine distinguishes outward pressure from the inward willing that must follow, in a passage later used in coercive controversies.

Historical and pastoral guardrail

This guide does not turn *compelle intrare* into a warrant for violence, forced sacramental profession, or confidence that exterior conformity equals faith. Cyril's insistence on voluntary belief and the parable's concern with genuine acceptance rule out that simplification. Augustine's account must be read in its late-antique polemical history, not silently converted into a timeless pastoral technique.

The widening invitation also rebukes contempt. The disabled and poor are not props in someone else's allegory; within Luke's narrative they are actual persons the host commands to be brought in. A spiritual reading is sound only if it strengthens rather than evades the Epistle's concrete demand to open one's goods to the brother in need.

First John: Sacrament, New Birth, and Charity in Deed

The Epistle does more than provide an ethical application after the parable. It distinguishes death and life, hatred and love, the world's goods and the brother's need, speech and deed, Christ's self-gift and ours. Augustine's *Homily 5 on First John* follows that internal order.

Augustine's locus	Direct exegesis of 1 John 3	Sacramental precision	Demand upon the invited guest
Section 6	Baptism marks the new person and remission of sins, but the heart must possess charity.	The sacramental mark is real; lack of charity does not make it imaginary, but it exposes a life not answering its grace.	Presence at the feast cannot be reduced to bodily access or verbal identity.
Section 10	Passing from death to life is known through love of the brethren. Augustine compares winter's apparently dead tree whose living root remains hidden.	Charity can be real before its mature fruit is fully visible, because divine life is rooted within.	The world may not recognize the life it cannot see; the Christian must let the hidden root issue in action.
Sections 11–12	Christ's laying down his life is charity's perfection; opening one's means to the needy is its serious beginning.	The same blood is the price of every redeemed brother, so sacramental communion forbids a merely private valuation of grace.	Love in deed starts with available material mercy and tends toward Christ-shaped self-gift.

Neither empty badge nor self-made worthiness

Augustine neither dismisses baptism when charity is lacking nor treats the sacramental mark as a guarantee that conduct no longer matters. The invited person receives a gift he did not prepare and is made responsible to live from it. Charity is evidence of passage into life because the life itself comes first from God.

The Psalms Retrain the Guest's Voice

Each chant verse has a substantial Augustinian exposition. These are direct interpretations of the appointed biblical words, although Augustine is not commenting on their later arrangement in this Mass. The movement from rescue, through truthful speech and hope, to petition and thanksgiving is an editorial liturgical synthesis.

Chant and verse	Augustine's direct exegesis	Conversion of the hearer	Source boundary
Introit, Psalm 17:19–20	In <i>Exposition on Psalm 17</i> , 20–21, the broad place is faith's spiritual breadth; deliverance rests on God's prior delight and mercy, with good will and clean deeds following the first gift.	The guest enters room created by grace before being sent to make room for another.	New Advent heads the page as Psalm 18; the missal follows Vulgate numbering.
Gradual, Psalm 119:1–2	In <i>Exposition on Psalm 119</i> , 2–8, the cry begins spiritual ascent. Deceitful tongues include counselors whose praise or advice draws the pilgrim away from Christ; God's word can become an arrow that converts an enemy.	The hearer asks to be freed from the speech that will soon appear as polished excuse, then learns to sing the psalm with the heart and life.	New Advent heads the page as Psalm 120.
Alleluia, Psalm 7:2	In <i>Exposition on Psalm 7</i> , 2, hope is placed in God against persecutors and, beneath them, the enemy figured as a tearing lion.	The world's hatred named by the Epistle is answered by trust and patient refusal to repay evil, not by self-rescue.	The devil-image belongs to Augustine's psalm exegesis, not to Luke's banquet characters.
Offertory, Psalm 6:5	In <i>Exposition on Psalm 6</i> , 5, "Turn, O Lord" can be heard as the plea that God make the sinner turn and assist a difficult return; salvation is sought for mercy, not merit.	The excuse-maker ceases explaining himself and asks God for the conversion he cannot perfect unaided.	This is direct exegesis of the psalm's imperative, not a gloss on the Secret.
Communion, Psalm 12:6	In <i>Exposition on Psalm 12</i> , 6, hope rests in divine mercy rather than self-stability; song belongs to the heart and is chanted publicly in works.	The tongue rescued from deceit answers received benefits with gratitude embodied in deed and truth.	New Advent heads the page as Psalm 13.

The Secret: Purified for the Conduct of Heaven

The Secret gives the moral demand a sacramental grammar. Its subject is the oblation; its repeated object is the worshippers. The prayer asks neither that they purify themselves nor merely that their existing conduct be approved.

Latin hinge	Syntactical force	Place in the Sunday's movement
<i>Oblatio ... tuo nomini dicanda</i>	The oblation is to be dedicated to the Lord's Name.	The Collect's fear and love of the holy Name reach the altar as consecrated action.
<i>nos ... purificet</i>	The oblation is asked to purify <i>us</i> .	Guests do not arrive as self-certified worthy recipients; divine gift cleanses those it summons.

Latin hinge	Syntactical force	Place in the Sunday's movement
<i>et de die in diem</i> ... <i>transferat</i>	The same <i>nos</i> naturally remains the object: may the oblation transfer us day by day.	Transformation is repeated and progressive, not exhausted by one moment of enthusiasm.
<i>ad caelestis vitae</i> ... <i>actionem</i>	The goal is the action, conduct, or way of life proper to heavenly life.	The banquet's anagogical promise enters present behavior; heaven begins to govern how the guest acts toward the brother.

St. Augustine — *City of God* X.5–6, 20

Augustine does not comment on this Secret, but his sacrificial account clarifies its logic. Every work ordered to holy union with God is true sacrifice; mercy toward the neighbor belongs to that order; body and soul are offered as the mind is transformed; and the whole redeemed city offers itself through Christ the High Priest. The altar's sacrament teaches the Church to become, through him, the self-offering it celebrates.

The relation to the Epistle is exact without being mechanical. First John says the faithful have passed from death to life and gives brotherly love as evidence. The Secret asks that sacramental oblation continue transferring them, day by day, into heaven's mode of action. An accomplished passage and an unfinished formation coexist because baptismal life has been given as a principle that must mature in charity.

The Postcommunion completes the same order. Having received the sacred gifts, the Church asks that repeated participation in the mystery increase salvation's effect. Frequency is not treated as bare repetition; it is ordered toward growth. The supper that was ready before the guest arrived becomes nourishment whose effect must appear in a life opened to God and neighbor.

A patristic listening sequence for the Mass

1. At the Introit, receive Augustine's "broad place" as the spiritual room created by prior mercy. In the Collect, ask to be established in reverence and love of the Name.
2. In First John, distinguish sacramental mark, hidden root, visible deed, material mercy, and perfected self-gift. Let the needy brother test whether the invitation has reached conduct.
3. At the Gradual and Alleluia, ask for rescue from deceptive counsel and place hope in God before hearing the guests' plausible explanations.
4. In the Gospel, compare Tertullian, Augustine, Cyril, and Gregory without forcing one role map. Attend to prepared gift, successive summons, ordered desire, and the widening house.
5. Hear the excuses through Augustine's threefold diagnosis, but do not condemn the created goods they misuse. Ask which good has become functionally exempt from God's claim.
6. At the Offertory, replace excuse with petition: Lord, turn and rescue for mercy's sake. In the Secret, hear the oblation dedicated to the Name purify and transfer the offerers day by day.
7. At Communion, let received benefit become a song chanted in works; in the Postcommunion, ask that repeated mystery produce increasing salvific effect.

Source boundaries to retain

- Augustine's psalm expositions, *Sermon 62*, and *Homily 5 on First John* are **direct patristic exegesis** of appointed biblical texts, though not commentaries on this Roman formulary.
- Tertullian and Cyril also interpret the appointed parable directly. Their role assignments, like Augustine's, are patristic allegorical readings rather than replacements for Luke's narrative sense.
- Gregory's account of desire and Augustine's *City of God* are **moral or doctrinal illumination**; Augustine is not being claimed as expositor or author of the Secret.
- The speech sequence, the bridge from broad place to full house, and the relation among the Epistle, Secret, and Postcommunion are **editorial liturgical syntheses** controlled by the cited texts.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *Dominica Secunda post Pentecosten*, Introit through Postcommunion; local OCR temporal corpus identified in the README. Latin OCR remains subject to printed-missal verification; psalm numbering follows the Vulgate.
- Holy Scripture: 1 John 2:15–17; 3:13–18; Luke 14:1, 15–24; Psalms 17, 119, 7, 6, and 12 in Vulgate numbering.
- Tertullian, *Against Marcion* IV.31, working public-domain text.
- St. Augustine, *Sermon 62* (92 in the Benedictine series), 1–8, on Luke 14:16–24, working public-domain text.
- St. Cyril of Alexandria, *Commentary on Luke*, Sermon 104, working public-domain text.
- St. Gregory the Great, *Homiliae in Evangelia* II.36; a public-domain English extract is preserved in the *Catena Aurea* compilation. The summary above does not claim that excerpt as a translation of the entire homily.
- St. Augustine, *Homily 5 on the First Epistle of John*, 6, 10–12, working public-domain text.
- St. Augustine, *Expositions on the Psalms*: Psalm 17, 20–21, working text; Psalm 119, 2–8, working text; Psalm 7, 2, working text; Psalm 6, 5, working text; Psalm 12, 6, working text. New Advent's headings use Psalms 18, 120, 7, 6, and 13 respectively.
- St. Augustine, *City of God* X.5–6, 20, visible sacrifice, charity, ecclesial self-offering, and the one High Priest.